Several pages

1 Pages

Long documents are set one page at a time. TeX's page builder collects lines, headings, displays and floats into a vertical list and breaks it where the cost is lowest, preferring not to leave a single line of a paragraph alone at the top or the bottom of a page.

Each page has the same text height, but with a ragged bottom the last line need not sit exactly on the bottom margin; the white space that remains is left below the text instead of being spread between the paragraphs.

Club and widow penalties discourage a page break after the first line or before the last line of a paragraph. They are not absolute, so a page may still end that way when every alternative is worse, but in ordinary prose the builder almost always finds a better place.

Headings are kept with the lines that follow them. A heading at the foot of a page with no text under it is one of the faults a careful compositor never lets through, and the page builder treats it as a forbidden break.

Footnotes, figures and tables complicate the picture, because they take room on a page that the builder must account for before it knows where the page will end. Here the text is plain, so only the lines and the headings matter.

2 Penalties

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4 Floats

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5 Summary

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